

PRESENTATION

FINAL DRAFT

TOPIC

Emotion as infrastructure.
Designing systems as acts of care
and collective intelligence.

AUDIENCE

For design peers, graduate faculty,
and design researchers exploring ethics,
systems thinking, and long-term product impact.

PURPOSE

Emotion is not an aesthetic afterthought, but the
structural core of sustainable and ethical design
systems. By treating emotion as core infrastructure,
designers can build products and communities
that nurture trust, care, and long-term intelligence
instead of exploiting attention.

THESIS

Emotion is behavior. Behavior reveals need.
Design translates need into a practice of care.

STORY TYPE

Rising action + Hero's Journey hybrid:
combining personal reflection, critical
analysis and systemic evidence.

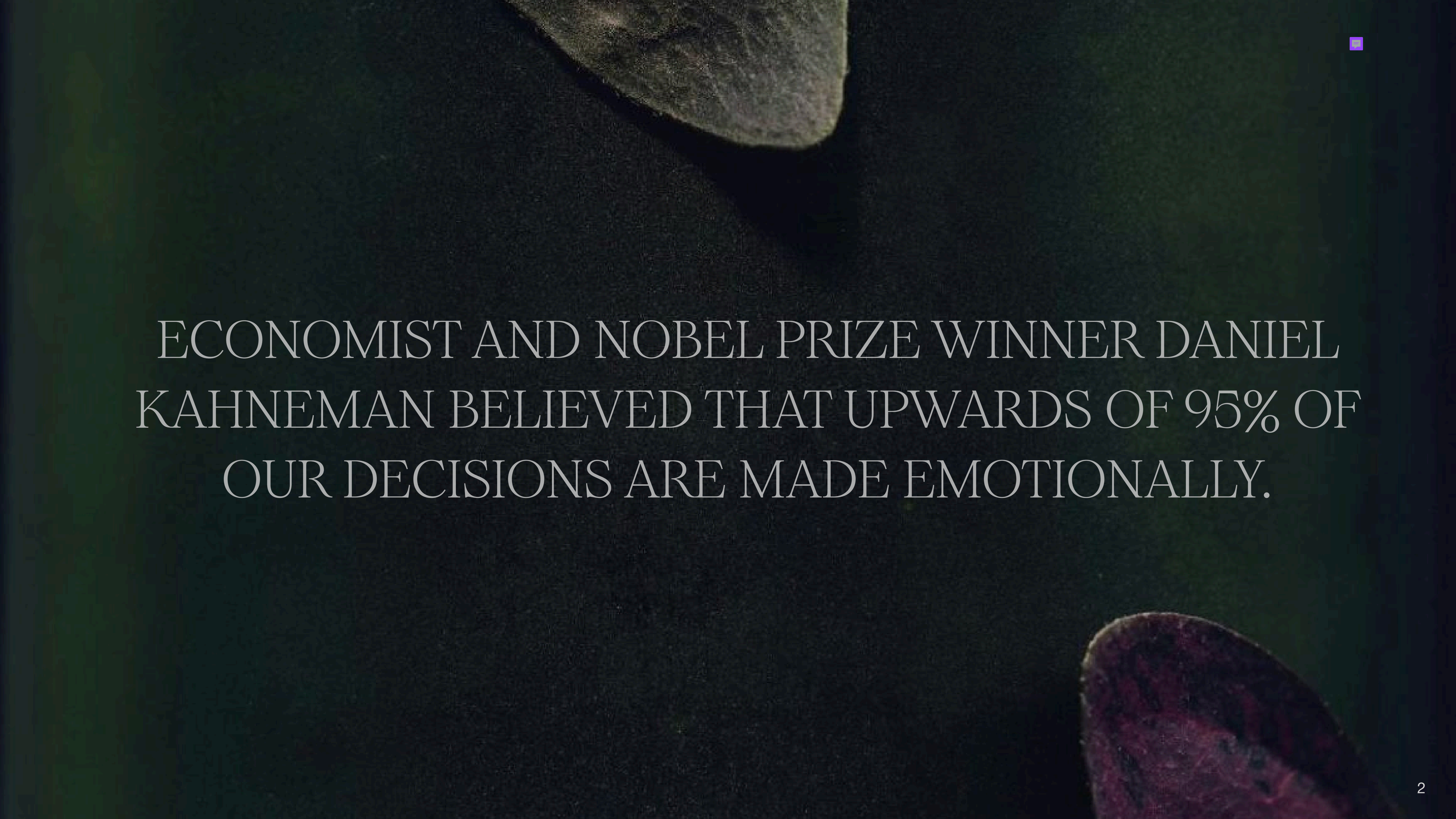
TAKEAWAYS

Emotion is design's most powerful system and its
greatest ethical test. Our role as designers is to
transform emotional design from manipulation to
stewardship.

A background image of blurred green leaves, creating a soft, naturalistic setting for the text.

EMOTIONAL INFRASTRUCTURE

DESIGN AS CARE AND COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE

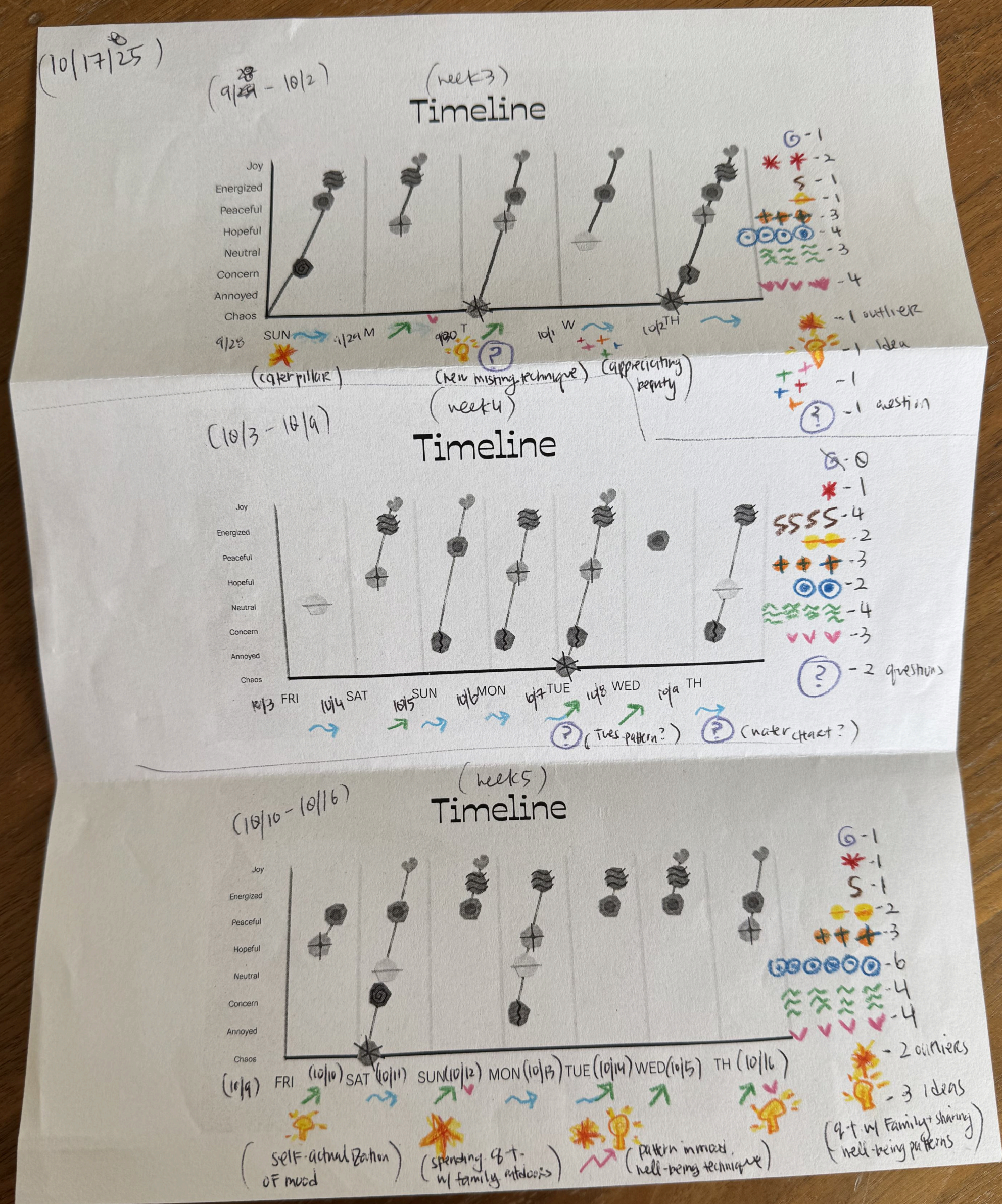
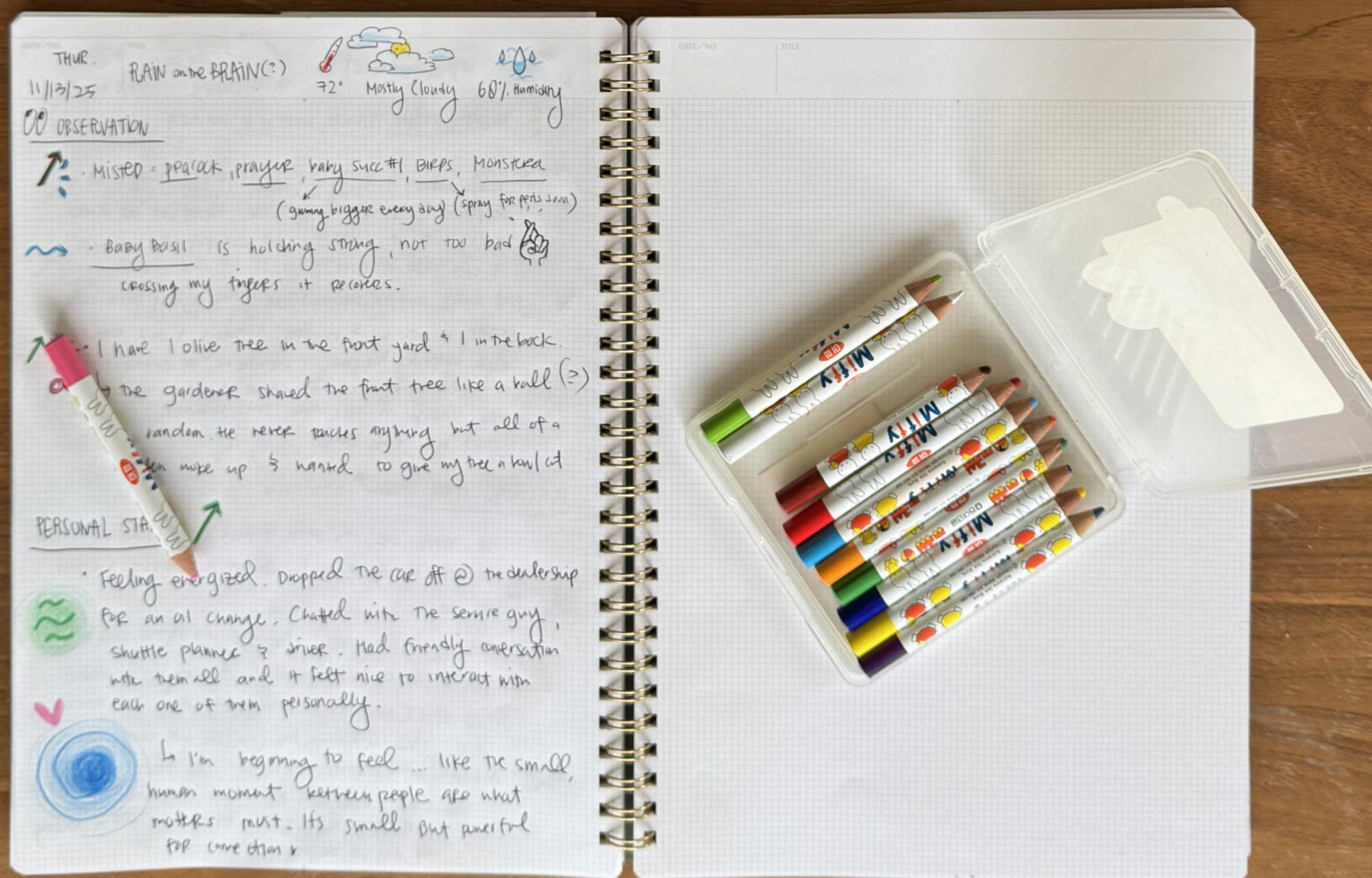


ECONOMIST AND NOBEL PRIZE WINNER DANIEL
KAHNEMAN BELIEVED THAT UPWARDS OF 95% OF
OUR DECISIONS ARE MADE EMOTIONALLY.



IT'S WHAT WE DO

THINKING FAST, THEN SLOW





LISTEN

WHAT DOES THE DATA SAY?

WHEN EMOTION BREAKS

DESIGN OVERRIDES THE SYSTEM

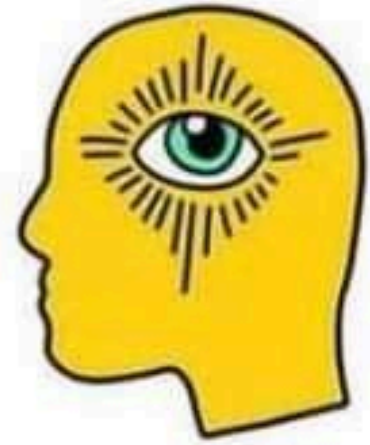


HOW'S YOUR BRAIN ?

@crazyheadcomics



SOMETIMES



MINDFUL



OUT OF
BATTERY



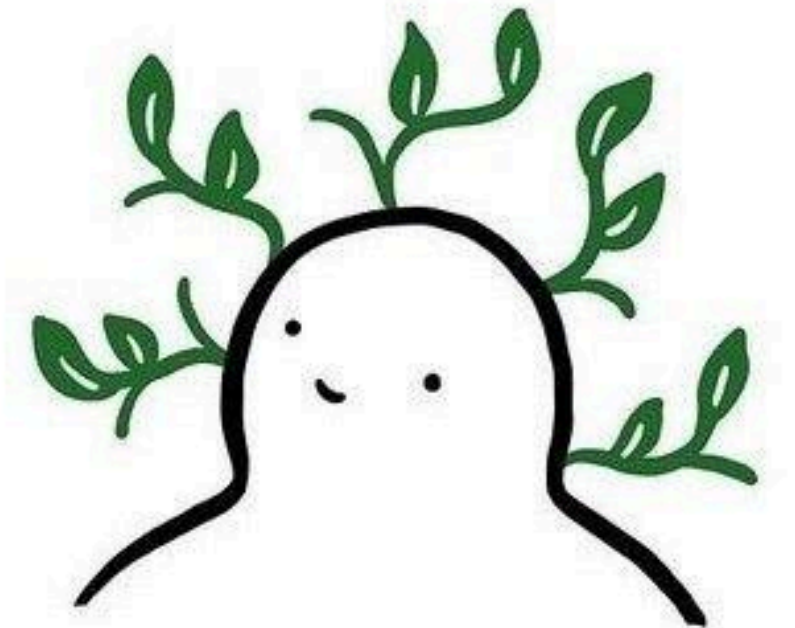
DAY-
DREAMY



SPIRALING



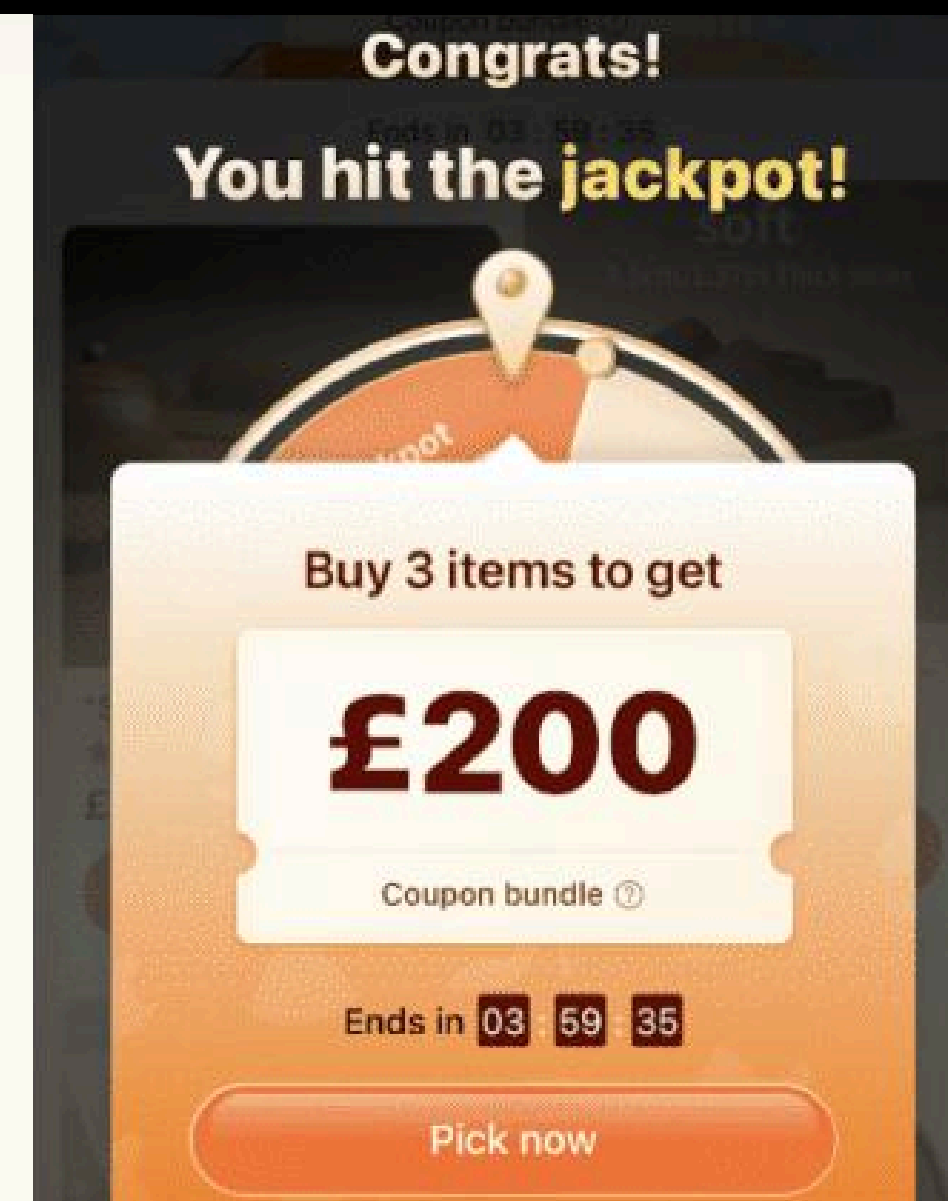
ORGANIZED
CHAOS



OTHERTIMES

Dark Patterns Are Now Illegal in the EU. Is Your Product Compliant?

Strategy, Product & Transformation
27 June 2025 - 4 minutes read



You made Duo sad 🥹

duolingo



We haven't seen you in
a while.



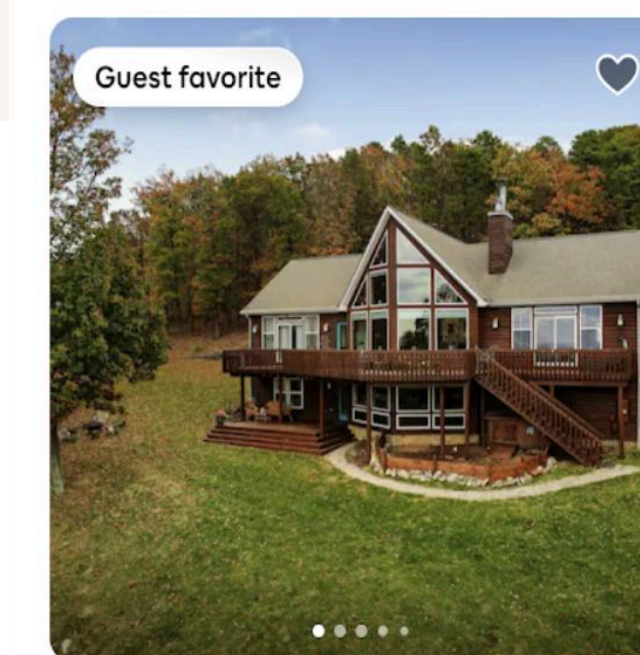
just got a \$3360 charge from @airtable because i invited some folks to review a base i made. no info that inviting folks would cost \$240 a year each.

¬_(_ツ)_/¬.

4:20 PM · Jun 15, 2020 · Twitter Web App

SIGN ME UP

NO THANKS,
I HATE FREE MONEY



Harpers Ferry, West Virginia ★ 5.0
47 miles away
Mar 10 - 15
\$167 night

Fake price: \$167/night

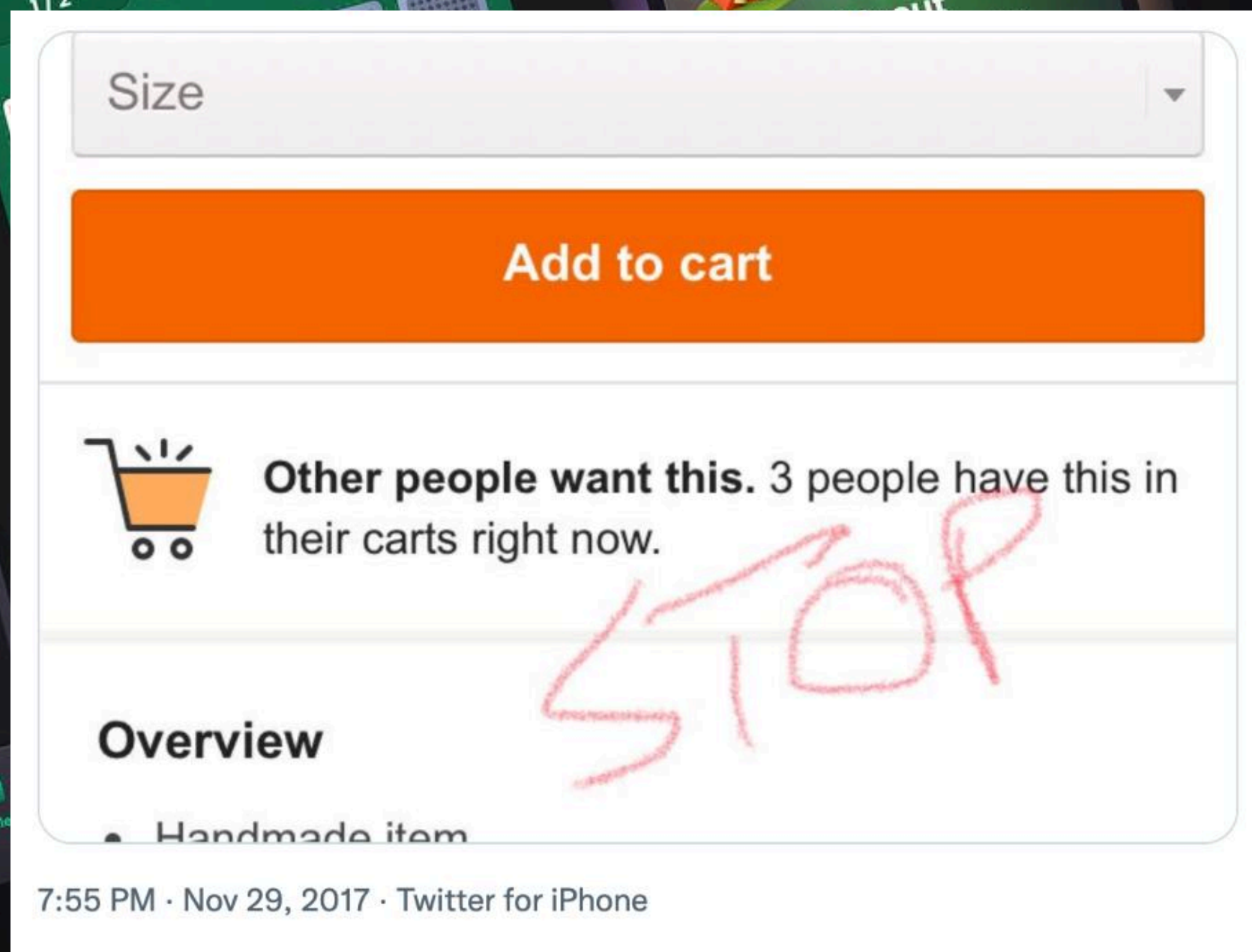


Tequila Sunset, Harpers Ferry 1st floor apartment
Entire home
★ 5.00 (13)

Price details

\$167.00 x 5 nights	\$835.00
<u>Cleaning fee</u>	\$85.00
<u>Airbnb service fee</u>	\$129.88
<u>Taxes</u>	\$118.19
Total (USD)	\$1,168.07

Real price: \$233.61/night



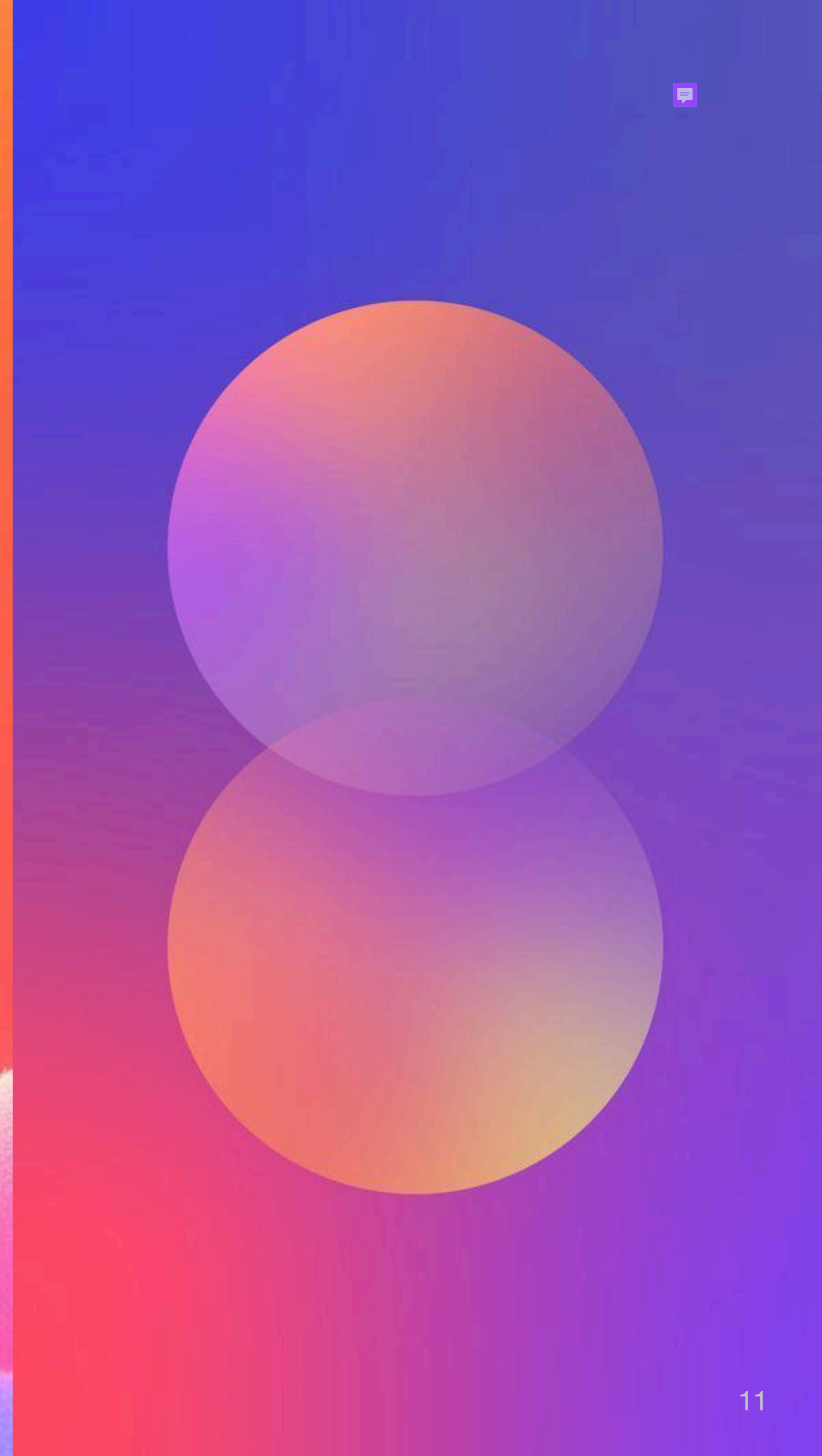
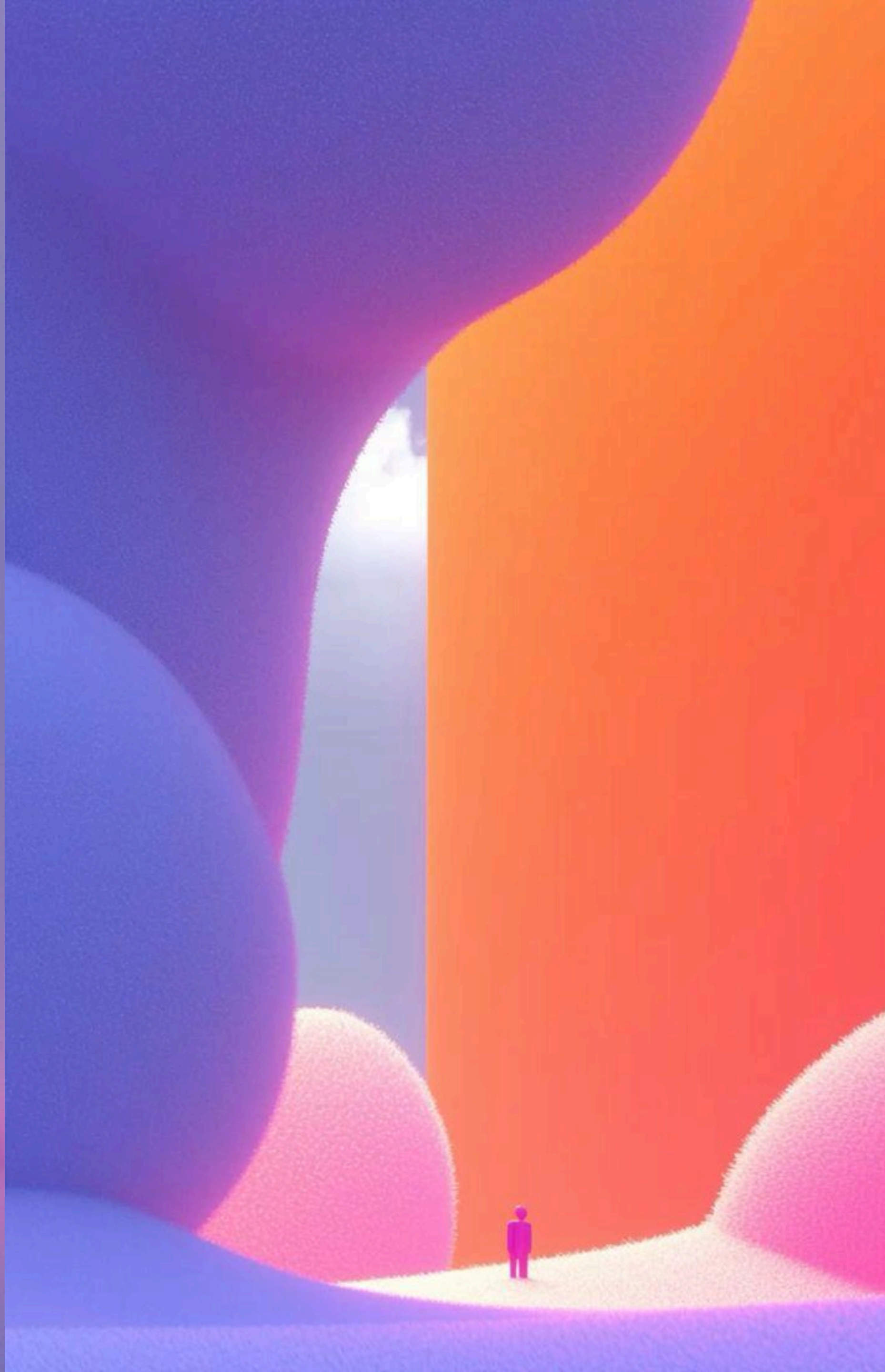
Epic Games Ordered To Pay \$245 Million In Refunds To Fortnite Players Tricked Into 'Unwanted Charges'

by [Wesley LeBlanc](#) on Mar 15, 2023 at 07:38 AM

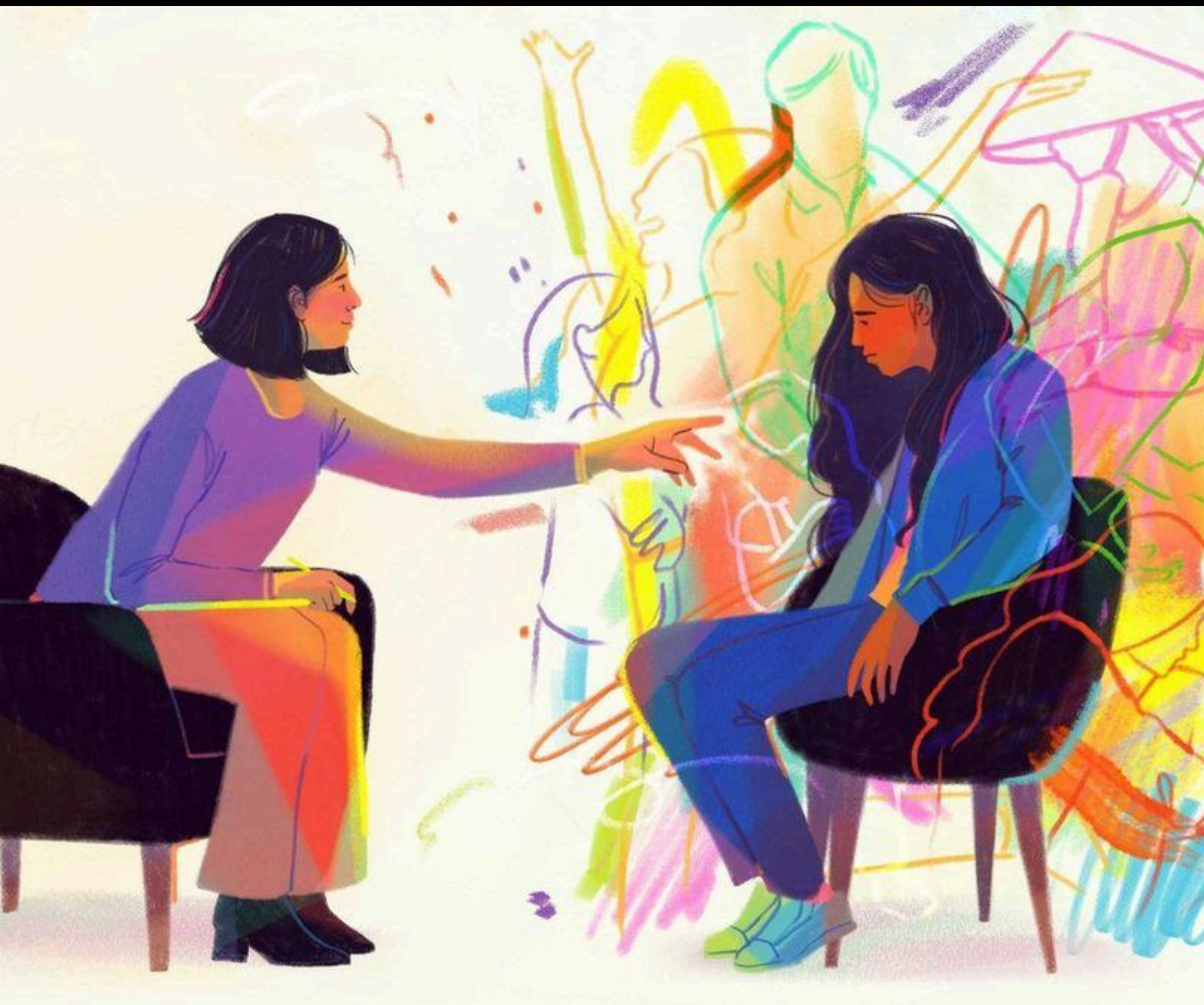


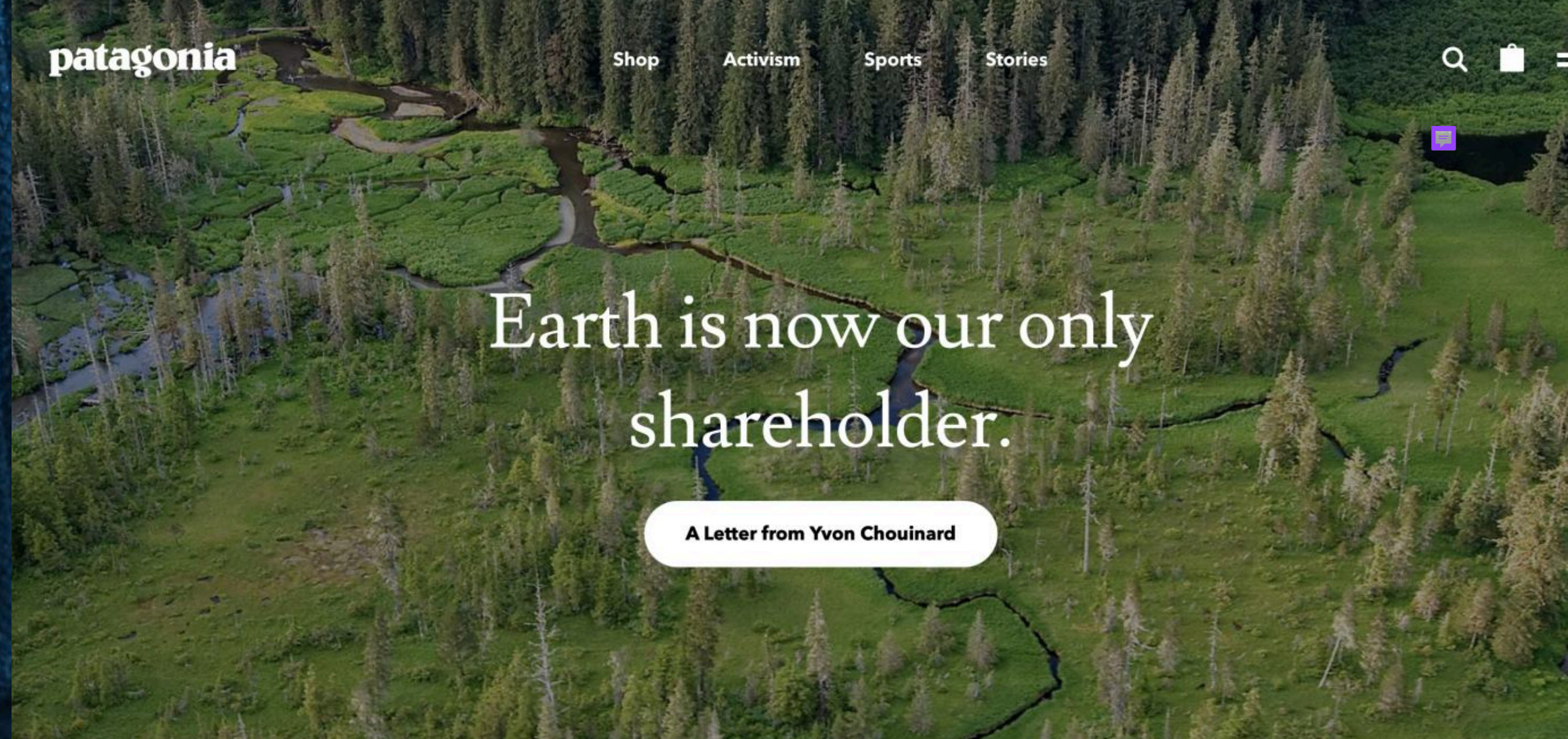
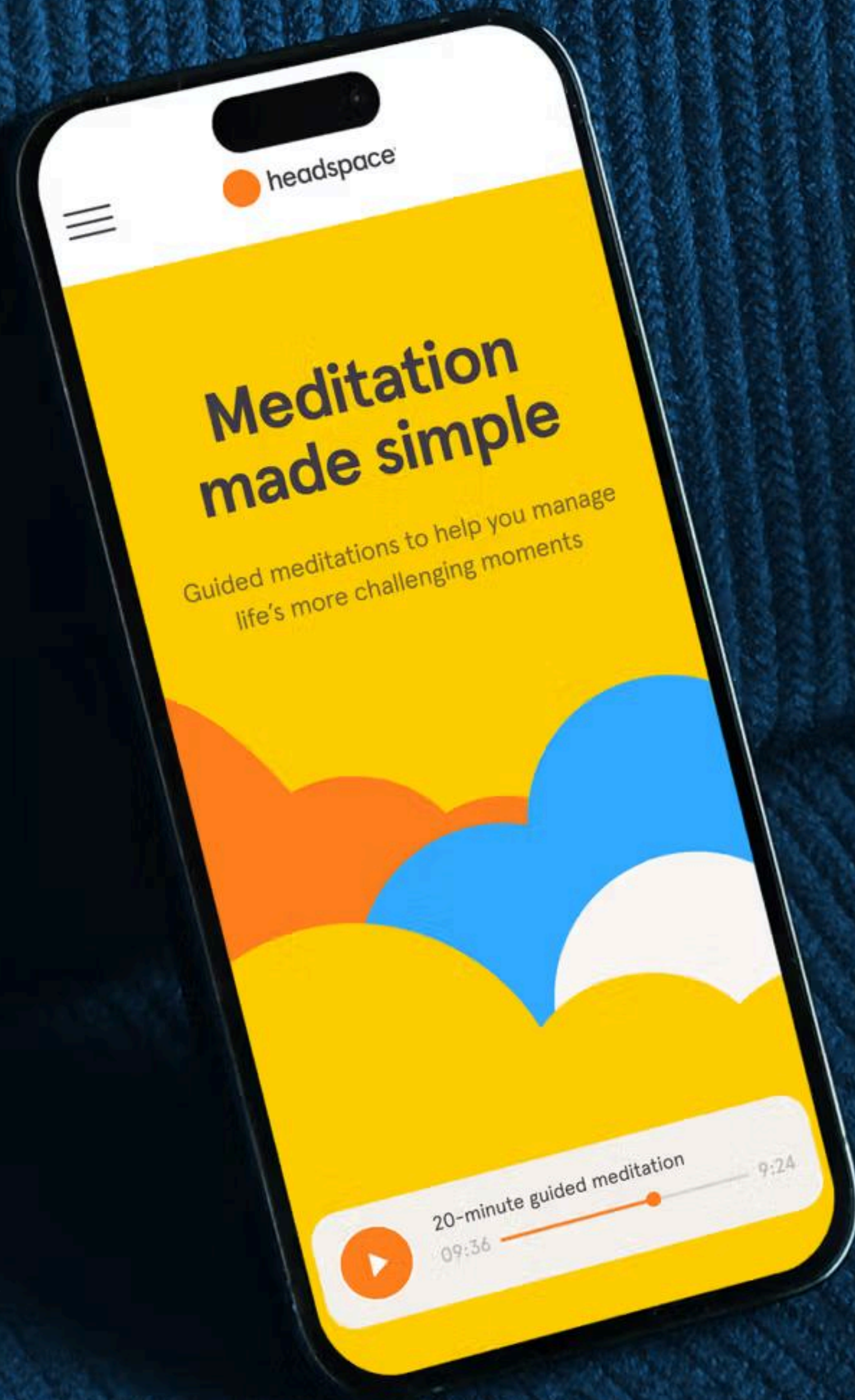
LEARN

WHERE CAN WE INTERVENE?





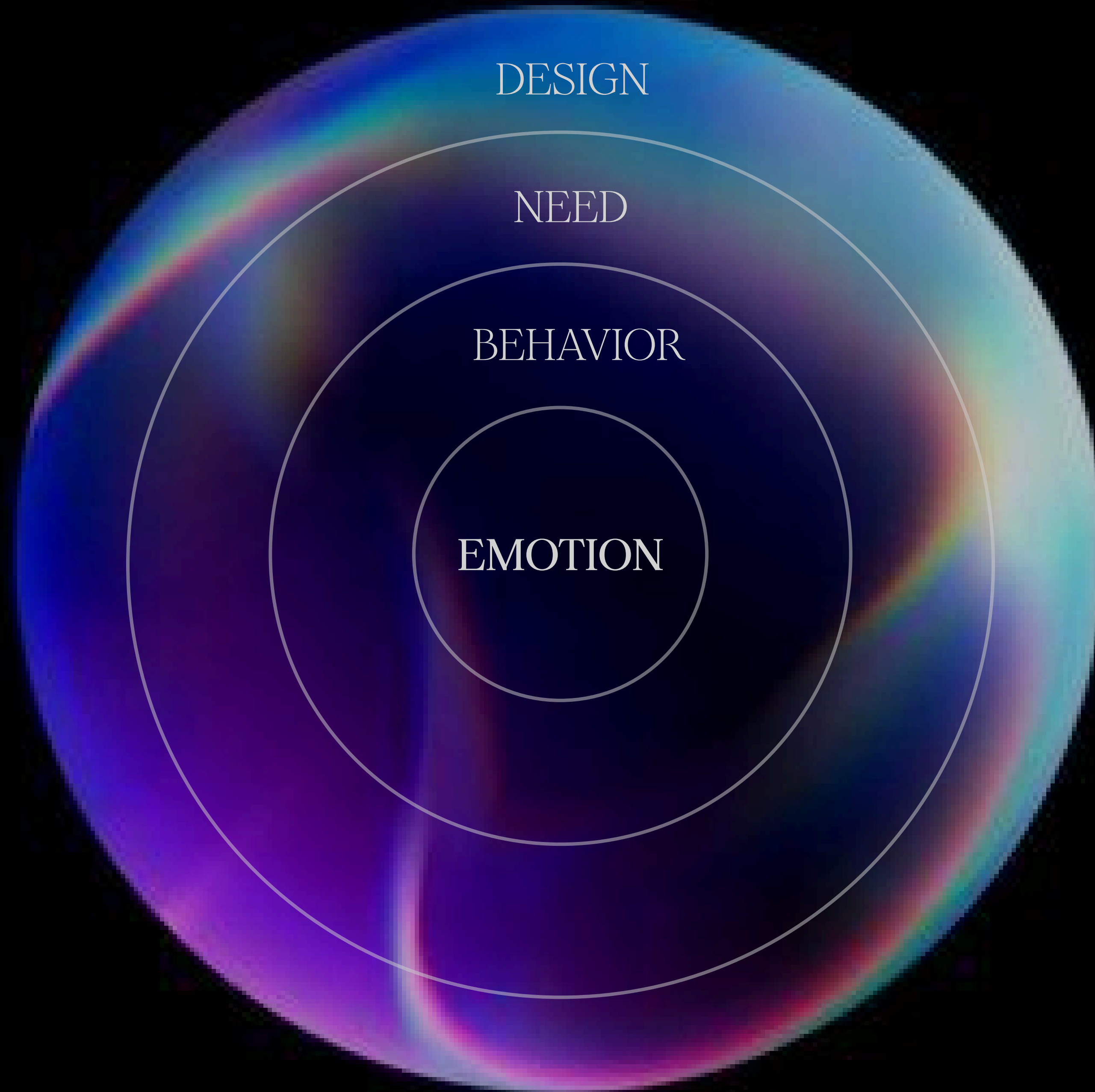




A close-up photograph of a bouquet of flowers, primarily orange and purple, set against a dark blue background. The flowers are slightly out of focus, creating a soft, artistic effect. The text is overlaid on the center of the image.

CARE

AS THE SOURCE CODE





4 PRINCIPLES

OBSERVE BEFORE SOLVING

Emotion before information.

RESPOND, DON'T REACT

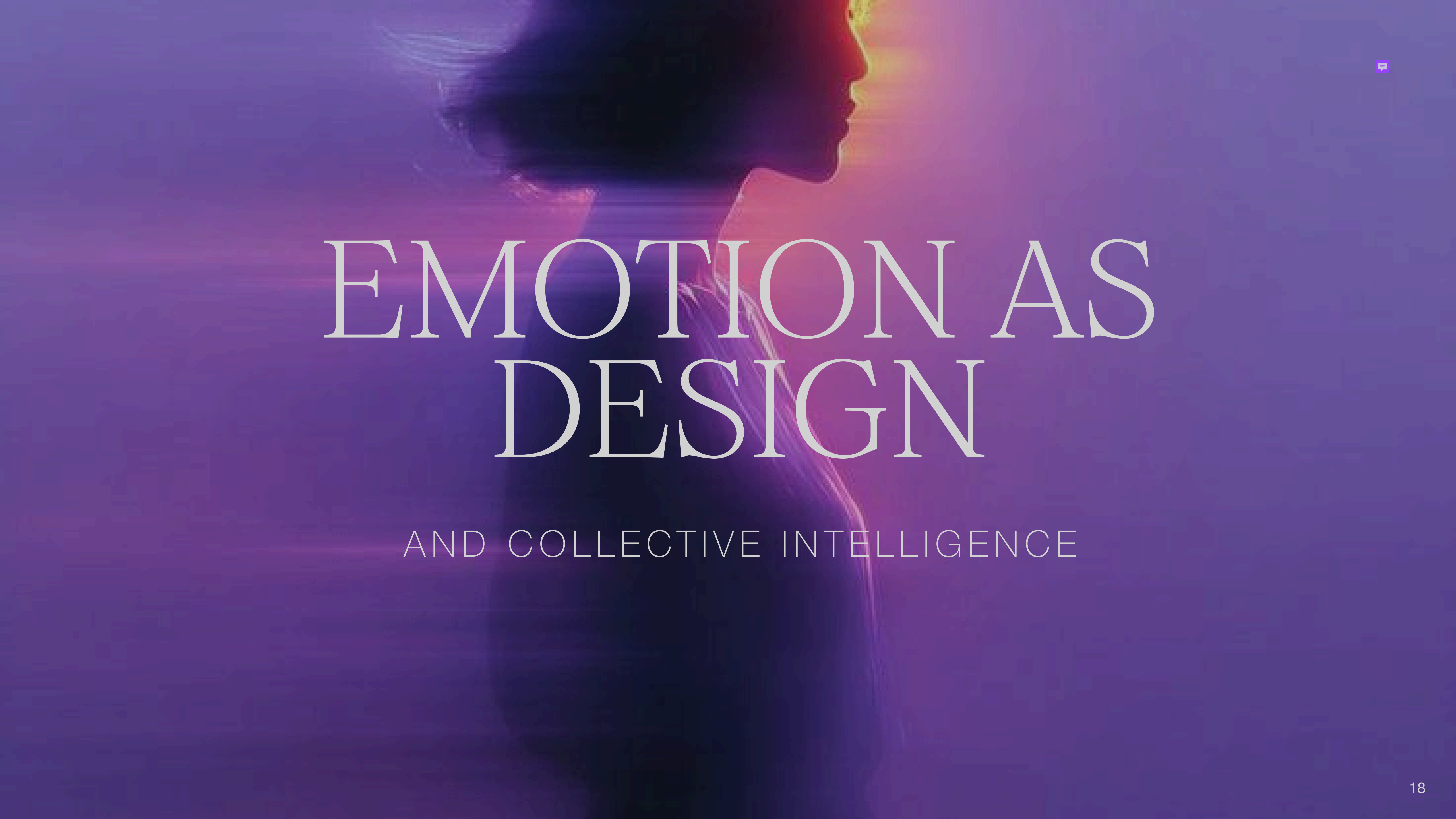
Feedback as care.

BE HONEST ABOUT INTENT

Transparency as trust.

MATCH A HUMAN TEMPO

Rhythm that builds resilience.



EMOTION AS DESIGN

AND COLLECTIVE INTELLIGENCE







THANK YOU

APPENDIX

REF & RES

REFERENCES

- Daniel Kahneman
Thinking Fast and Slow
- (APA) American Psychological Association
The Science Behind Creativity
- National Library of Medicine
Gardening for health
- (CBTW) Collaboration Betters The World
Dark Patterns Are Now Illegal In the EU
- The MIT Press Reader
The Extraordinary Way Rhythm Shapes Our Lives
- The Architecture Review
Roberto Burle Marx
- Headspace
A Mental Health App for Medication & Sleep
- Patagonia
Outdoor Clothing & Gear
- Lofi Girl YouTube Channel
Connecting people through music

RESOURCES

“ALT MariaClara is a font dedicated to the strong, confident, brave Filipina women who are breaking away from stereotypes and owning their identities. Named after Maria Clara, a fictional Filipina character who became a colonial figure—an embodiment of submissive, conservative demureness, a myth that allowed Spanish colonisers to continue to subjugate Filipina women—ALT MariaClara flips the narrative. Drawing inspiration from the visual history of the Philippines, type designer Alli Cunanan incorporates sharp, intricate details.”

<https://alt-tf.com/products/alt-maria-clara>

“Death To Stock is proudly owned and run by People of Color. DTS has dedicated its focus to the creator economy by collaborating with the world's best artists to build a media company that brands love. A beautiful, premium stock media library that helps you build your own unique digital brand.”

<https://www.deathtothestockphoto.com/>